

Al Noor General Hospital - Policy Manual

Version 3.0 | Effective January 2026 | Official policy document (sample for testing)

1. Visitor Policy

Visiting hours for all general wards are from 4:00 PM to 8:00 PM every day, including weekends and public holidays. Visitors must register at the main reception and wear a visitor badge for the whole visit.

A maximum of 2 visitors are allowed at the bedside of a patient at the same time. Additional family members may wait in the ground-floor lounge.

Children under 12 years are not permitted in general wards, except with written approval from the ward nurse in charge. Visitors with fever, cough or any infectious symptoms must not enter patient areas.

Intensive Care Unit (ICU) visits are limited to 15 minutes per visit and only 1 visitor at a time. ICU visits must be approved by the nurse in charge.

Flowers, uncooked food and outside medication are not allowed in patient rooms. Mobile phones must be on silent inside the wards.

2. Admission and Discharge

Patients must bring a valid Emirates ID or passport, their insurance card and any previous medical reports at the time of admission. Emergency patients are admitted first and documents can be submitted within 24 hours.

The standard discharge time is 12:00 noon. Patients who remain in the room after 12:00 noon may be charged for an additional day. The discharge process starts after the treating doctor signs the discharge summary and the billing department clears the final bill.

3. Infection Control

All staff must follow the 5 Moments of Hand Hygiene: before touching a patient, before a clean or aseptic procedure, after body fluid exposure, after touching a patient, and after touching patient surroundings.

Alcohol-based hand rub is available at every bed. Staff must wash hands with soap and water for at least 40 seconds when hands are visibly dirty.

Personal protective equipment (PPE) such as gloves, masks and gowns must be changed between patients. Any needle-stick injury must be reported to the Infection Control Unit within 1 hour.

4. Staff Leave and Incident Reporting

New joiners are entitled to 14 days of paid annual leave in their first year of service. From the second year onwards, employees receive 22 days of paid annual leave per year.

Sick leave requires a medical certificate for absences longer than 2 consecutive days. Staff on probation may not take more than 5 consecutive days of annual leave.

All patient safety incidents and near-misses must be reported in the incident reporting system within 12 hours of the event. Serious incidents must also be reported verbally to the department head immediately.

5. Patient Privacy and Medical Records

Patient information is confidential and may only be shared with the patient, their authorised representative, or as required by law. Staff must not discuss patient details in public areas such as lifts, corridors or the cafeteria.

Medical records are kept for a minimum of 25 years. A patient may request a copy of their medical records in writing, and the hospital will respond within 5 working days.